

# Inputs of Equivariant Infinite Loop Space Machines

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# 1 Abstract

Symmetric monoidal categories are central studies in modern algebraic topology, for instance  $K$ -theory relies on constructing spectra with suitable homotopy groups out of symmetric monoidal categories using the infinite loop space machine. It's known that the two inputs - pseudoalgebra over an operad  $\mathcal{P}$ , or suitable categories described by based finite sets  $\mathcal{F}$  - are equivalent description for symmetric monoidal categories.

Within equivariant  $K$ -theory, similar machineries have been established, where the input for constructing  $G$ -spectra are described by pseudoalgebra over an operad  $\mathcal{P}_G$  as  $G$ -categories, or categories described by based finite  $G$ -sets  $\mathcal{F}_G$ . The equivalence of the two within equivariant case is a natural question to ask, and associates to the question of “what is symmetric monoidal  $G$ -categories”.

We'll provide an exposition on the two inputs by collecting the axioms scattered (or implicitly assumed) in various literatures, while describe some equivariance properties of the two inputs.

# 2 Introduction (ND)

### 3 Categorical Preliminaries

#### 3.1 2-Categories

**Definition 3.1.** A category  $\mathcal{C}$  is a *2-category*, if for each object  $X, Y \in \mathcal{C}$  (called *0-cells*), the homset  $\mathcal{C}(X, Y)$  is itself a category (called the *hom-category*). Also, for every 0-cells  $X, Y, Z \in \mathcal{C}$ , the *composition*  $\circ : \mathcal{C}(Y, Z) \times \mathcal{C}(X, Y) \rightarrow \mathcal{C}(X, Z)$  is a functor.

Every morphism  $f \in \mathcal{C}(X, Y)$  is called a *1-cell*, while given any 1-cells  $f, g \in \mathcal{C}(X, Y)$ , a morphism  $\alpha : f \Rightarrow g$  in the hom-category  $\mathcal{C}(X, Y)$  is called a *2-cell*.

Here,  $\circ$  must be strictly unital and associative.

**Remark 3.2.** There is a more general notion of a *bicategory*, which relaxes the composition functors to be associative and unital up to coherent natural isomorphisms, and in some literature this is called 2-categories. Here we'll take the strict associativity and unitality as axioms for 2-categories. For more general bicategory, cf. [7] Section 2.1.

**Example 3.3.** Let **Cat** denote the *category of small categories*, where the objects are small categories, the hom-categories **Cat**( $\mathcal{A}, \mathcal{B}$ ) are functors between small categories  $\mathcal{A}$  and  $\mathcal{B}$ , and the morphisms in **Cat**( $\mathcal{A}, \mathcal{B}$ ) are natural transformations between functors. This specifies **Cat** to be a 2-category.

#### 3.2 Pseudofunctor, Pseudotransform, and Modification

**Definition 3.4** (Pseudofunctor). Given two 2-categories  $\mathcal{A}, \mathcal{B}$ , a *pseudofunctor*  $F : \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$  equips with an 0-cell map, functors between hom-categories  $F_{X,Y} : \mathcal{A}(X, Y) \rightarrow \mathcal{B}(F(X), F(Y))$ , an invertible 2-cell  $\phi_{X,Y,Z}$  between compositions

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{A}(Y, Z) \times \mathcal{A}(X, Y) & \xrightarrow{F_{Y,Z} \times F_{X,Y}} & \mathcal{B}(F(Y), F(Z)) \times \mathcal{B}(F(X), F(Y)) \\ \downarrow \circ & \swarrow \phi_{X,Y,Z} & \downarrow \circ \\ \mathcal{A}(X, Z) & \xrightarrow{F_{X,Z}} & \mathcal{B}(F(X), F(Z)) \end{array}$$

and another invertible 2-cell  $\psi_X$  between identities

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & \text{id}_{F(X)} & \\ & \downarrow & \\ F(X) & \xrightarrow{\psi_X} & F(X) \\ & \downarrow F_{X,X}(\text{id}_X) & \end{array}$$

that satisfies:

(i) **(Associativity)** The following two pasting diagrams are equal:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{A}(Z, W) \times \mathcal{A}(Y, Z) \times \mathcal{A}(X, Y) & \xrightarrow{\Pi F_{\cdot, \cdot}} & \mathcal{B}(F(Z), F(W)) \times \mathcal{B}(F(Y), F(Z)) \times \mathcal{B}(F(X), F(Y)) \\ \downarrow \circ \times \text{id} & \swarrow \phi_{Y,Z,W} \times \text{id} & \downarrow \circ \times \text{id} \\ \mathcal{A}(Y, W) \times \mathcal{A}(X, Y) & \xrightarrow{F_{Y,W} \times F_{X,Y}} & \mathcal{B}(F(Y), F(W)) \times \mathcal{B}(F(X), F(Y)) \\ \downarrow \circ & \swarrow \phi_{X,Y,W} & \downarrow \circ \\ \mathcal{A}(X, W) & \xrightarrow{F_{X,W}} & \mathcal{B}(F(X), F(W)) \end{array}$$

equals

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\mathcal{A}(Z, W) \times \mathcal{A}(Y, Z) \times \mathcal{A}(X, Y) & \xrightarrow{\Pi F_{-, -}} & \mathcal{B}(F(Z), F(W)) \times \mathcal{B}(F(Y), F(Z)) \times \mathcal{B}(F(X), F(Y)) \\
\downarrow \text{id} \times \circ & \swarrow \text{id} \times \phi_{X, Y, Z} & \downarrow \text{id} \times \circ \\
\mathcal{A}(Z, W) \times \mathcal{A}(X, Z) & \xrightarrow{F_{Z, W} \times F_{X, Z}} & \mathcal{B}(F(Z), F(W)) \times \mathcal{B}(F(X), F(Z)) \\
\downarrow \circ & \swarrow \phi_{X, Z, W} & \downarrow \circ \\
\mathcal{A}(X, W) & \xrightarrow{F_{X, W}} & \mathcal{B}(F(X), F(W))
\end{array}$$

(ii) **(Unitality)** The following two unit diagrams commute:

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\mathcal{A}(X, Y) \times \mathcal{A}(X, X) & \xrightarrow{F_{X, Y} \times F_{X, X}} & \mathcal{B}(F(X), F(Y)) \times \mathcal{B}(F(X), F(X)) \\
\uparrow \text{id} \times \text{id}_X & \nearrow \text{id} * \psi_X & \downarrow \circ \\
\mathcal{A}(X, Y) \times * & & \mathcal{B}(F(X), F(Y)) \\
\downarrow F_{X, Y} \times \text{id}_{F(X)} & \nwarrow & \downarrow \circ \\
\mathcal{B}(F(X), F(Y)) \times \mathcal{B}(F(X), F(X)) & \xrightarrow{\circ} & \mathcal{B}(F(X), F(Y))
\end{array}$$

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\mathcal{A}(Y, Y) \times \mathcal{A}(X, Y) & \xrightarrow{F_{Y, Y} \times F_{X, Y}} & \mathcal{B}(F(Y), F(Y)) \times \mathcal{B}(F(X), F(Y)) \\
\uparrow \text{id}_Y \times \text{id} & \nearrow \psi_Y * \text{id} & \downarrow \circ \\
* \times \mathcal{A}(X, Y) & & \mathcal{B}(F(Y), F(Y)) \\
\downarrow \text{id}_{F(Y)} \times F_{X, Y} & \nwarrow & \downarrow \circ \\
\mathcal{B}(F(Y), F(Y)) \times \mathcal{B}(F(X), F(Y)) & \xrightarrow{\circ} & \mathcal{B}(F(X), F(Y))
\end{array}$$

where  $\text{id}_X : * \rightarrow \mathcal{A}(X, X)$  is the functor indicating identity of  $X$ .

If  $\psi_X$  is identity 2-cell for all 0-cell  $X$ , then the pseudofunctor  $F$  is called *normal*.

**Definition 3.5** (Pseudotransform). Fix 2-categories  $\mathcal{A}, \mathcal{B}$ , let  $(F, \phi, \psi), (G, \varphi, \vartheta) : \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$  be two pseudofunctors. A *pseudotransform*  $\mu : (F, \phi, \psi) \rightarrow (G, \varphi, \vartheta)$  collects 1-cells  $\mu_X : F(X) \rightarrow G(X)$  for each 0-cell  $X \in \mathcal{A}$ , and for each 1-cell  $f : X \rightarrow Y$  in  $\mathcal{A}$ , associates a 2-cell  $\mu f$  such that

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
F(X) & \xrightarrow{\mu_X} & G(X) \\
Ff \downarrow & \swarrow \mu f & \downarrow Gf \\
F(Y) & \xrightarrow{\mu_Y} & G(Y)
\end{array}$$

commutes. They also satisfy:

(i) **(Associativity)** Let  $f : X \rightarrow Y, g : Y \rightarrow Z$  be 1-cells in  $\mathcal{A}$ , the following two pasting diagrams are

equal:

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 F(X) & \xrightarrow{\mu_X} & G(X) \\
 \downarrow Ff & \searrow \mu_f & \downarrow Gf \\
 F(g \circ f) & \xleftarrow{\phi_{g,f}} F(Y) & \xrightarrow{\mu_Y} G(Y) \\
 \downarrow Fg & \searrow \mu_g & \downarrow Gg \\
 F(Z) & \xrightarrow{\mu_Z} & G(Z)
 \end{array}
 =
 \begin{array}{ccc}
 F(X) & \xrightarrow{\mu_X} & G(X) \\
 \downarrow F(g \circ f) & \searrow \mu(g \circ f) & \downarrow G(g \circ f) \\
 F(Z) & \xrightarrow{\mu_Z} & G(Z)
 \end{array}$$

(ii) **(Unitality)** The following pasting diagrams are equal:

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 F(X) & \xrightarrow{\mu_X} & G(X) \\
 \downarrow F(\text{id}_X) & \searrow \psi_X & \downarrow \text{id}_{F(X)} \\
 F(X) & \xrightarrow{\mu_X} & G(X)
 \end{array}
 =
 \begin{array}{ccc}
 F(X) & \xrightarrow{\mu_X} & G(X) \\
 \downarrow F(\text{id}_X) & \searrow \mu(\text{id}_X) & \downarrow \text{id}_{G(X)} \\
 F(X) & \xrightarrow{\mu_X} & G(X)
 \end{array}$$

**Definition 3.6** (Modification). Continue with the same notation as above. Let  $\mu, \nu : (F, \phi, \psi) \rightarrow (G, \varphi, \vartheta)$  be two pseudotransforms, a *modification*  $\lambda : \mu \Rightarrow \nu$  is a collection of 2-cells  $\lambda_X : \mu_X \Rightarrow \nu_X$  for each 0-cell  $X \in \mathcal{A}$ , such that the following two pasting diagrams are equal, for each 1-cell  $f : X \rightarrow Y$  in  $\mathcal{A}$ :

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 F(X) & \xrightarrow{\mu_X} & G(X) \\
 \downarrow Ff & \searrow \lambda_X & \downarrow Gf \\
 F(Y) & \xrightarrow{\nu_Y} & G(Y)
 \end{array}
 =
 \begin{array}{ccc}
 F(X) & \xrightarrow{\mu_X} & G(X) \\
 \downarrow Ff & \searrow \mu_f & \downarrow Gf \\
 F(Y) & \xrightarrow{\lambda_Y} & G(Y)
 \end{array}$$

### 3.3 $G$ -Categories

**Definition 3.7.** A small category  $\mathcal{A}$  is a  $G$ -category, if the object and morphism sets  $\text{Ob}(\mathcal{A}), \text{Mor}(\mathcal{A})$  are both (left)  $G$ -sets, such that the following four structure maps  $(S, T, I, C)$  (stands for *source*, *target*, *identity*, and *composition*) are all  $G$ -equivariant:

- $S, T : \text{Mor}(\mathcal{A}) \rightarrow \text{Ob}(\mathcal{A})$  by  $S(X \xrightarrow{f} Y) := X$ , and  $T(X \xrightarrow{f} Y) := Y$ .
- $I : \text{Ob}(\mathcal{A}) \rightarrow \text{Mor}(\mathcal{A})$  by  $I(X) := \text{id}_X$ .
- $C : \text{Mor}(\mathcal{A}) \times_{S,T} \text{Mor}(\mathcal{A}) \rightarrow \text{Mor}(\mathcal{A})$  by  $C(g, f) := g \circ f$ .

Here,  $\text{Mor}(\mathcal{A}) \times_{S,T} \text{Mor}(\mathcal{A}) := \{(g, f) \in \text{Mor}(\mathcal{A})^2 \mid S(g) = T(f)\}$ , precisely the pair of morphisms that're composable, and it endows  $G$ -set structure via restricting the diagonal  $G$ -action on  $\text{Mor}(\mathcal{A})^2$ . This is well-defined due to the assumption  $S, T$  are  $G$ -maps.

Another equivalent characterization can be viewed as a group homomorphism  $G \rightarrow \text{Aut}_{\mathbf{Cat}}(\mathcal{A})$ , which assigns each  $g \in G$  an automorphism functor on  $\mathcal{A}$  such that composition respects  $G$ 's multiplication structure, and identity gets sent to the identity functor. So, from now on we view each element  $g \in G$  as a functor, whenever a category is specified as a  $G$ -category.

**Definition 3.8.** Let  $\mathbf{Cat}_G$  denotes the 2-category of small  $G$ -categories, with (nonequivariant) functors as 1-cells, natural transformations as 2-cells. The hom-category between any two  $G$ -categories  $\mathbf{Cat}_G(\mathcal{A}, \mathcal{B})$  also has a natural  $G$ -action via conjugation. Which, the  $G$ -fixed subcategory of the hom-category  $[\mathbf{Cat}_G(\mathcal{A}, \mathcal{B})]^G$  precisely describes all  $G$ -functor, or the functors  $F : \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$  such that  $g \circ F = F \circ g$  for all  $g \in G$ .

Another important notion is the twisted  $G$ -action on products when given a group homomorphism  $\alpha : G \rightarrow \Sigma_n$ . Given a category  $\mathcal{A}$ , the  $n$ -fold product  $\mathcal{A}^{\mathbf{n}}$  has a natural left  $\Sigma_n$ -action via permuting the coordinates; if  $\mathcal{A}$  is a  $G$ -category,  $\mathcal{A}^{\mathbf{n}}$  also endows a natural diagonal  $G$ -action. The two coordinates to give a natural left  $(G \times \Sigma_n)$ -action on  $\mathcal{A}^{\mathbf{n}}$ .

**Definition 3.9.** Let  $\mathcal{A}^{\mathbf{n}^\alpha}$  be a  $G$ -category with the underlying category being  $\mathcal{A}^{\mathbf{n}}$ , with the  $G$ -action defined as follow:

$$g \cdot_\alpha (X_1, \dots, X_n) := (g \cdot X_{\alpha(g)^{-1}(1)}, \dots, g \cdot X_{\alpha(g)^{-1}(n)})$$

Another characterization can be understood as follow: Given the graph subgroup  $\Gamma_\alpha := \{(g, \alpha(g)) \in G \times \Sigma_n\}_{g \in G}$ , the projection  $\pi_G : G \times \Sigma_n \rightarrow G$  restricts to an isomorphism  $\Gamma_\alpha \xrightarrow{\sim} G$ . The  $\alpha$ -twisted action is induced by the pullback along this isomorphism.

### 3.4 Chaotic-Forgetful Adjunction

Given any small category  $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbf{Cat}$ , its object  $\text{Ob}(\mathcal{A})$  forms a set; moreover, any functor  $F : \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$  also has an underlying map of objects  $F : \text{Ob}(\mathcal{A}) \rightarrow \text{Ob}(\mathcal{B})$ . Conversely, given a set, it has certain category structure:

**Definition 3.10.** Given a set  $X$ , define  $\mathcal{E}X$  to be the *chaotic category* with underlying object set  $\text{Ob}(\mathcal{E}X) := X$ , by encoding a unique isomorphism  $x \xrightarrow{\sim} y$  between any element  $x, y \in X$ . The composition

$$(x \xrightarrow{\sim} y \xrightarrow{\sim} z) = (x \xrightarrow{\sim} z) \tag{3.11}$$

using the uniqueness.

Given a set map  $f : X \rightarrow Y$ , define the functor  $\mathcal{E}f : \mathcal{E}X \rightarrow \mathcal{E}Y$  so that the underlying object map is  $f$ , and for each morphism  $x \xrightarrow{\sim} y$  in  $\mathcal{E}X$ ,  $\mathcal{E}f(x \rightarrow y) := f(x) \rightarrow f(y)$ , the unique morphism between  $f(x), f(y)$  in  $\mathcal{E}Y$ .

Inspecting the definition, we see  $\mathcal{E} : \mathbf{Set} \rightarrow \mathbf{Cat}$  is a well-defined functor, called the *chaotic functor*.

Notice if a functor  $F : \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$  has a chaotic target  $\mathcal{B}$ , then all the morphisms  $f : X \rightarrow Y$  in  $\mathcal{A}$  must be sent to the unique morphism  $F(X) \rightarrow F(Y)$  in  $\mathcal{B}$ , hence  $F$  is dictated by the object map  $F : \text{Ob}(\mathcal{A}) \rightarrow \text{Ob}(\mathcal{B})$ . Such uniqueness specifies an adjunction  $(\text{Ob} \dashv \mathcal{E})$ .

The consequence is the following natural isomorphism of homset for any two sets  $X, Y$ :

$$\mathbf{Set}(X, Y) = \mathbf{Set}(\text{Ob}(\mathcal{E}X), Y) \cong \mathbf{Cat}(\mathcal{E}X, \mathcal{E}Y) \tag{3.12}$$

**Remark 3.13.** Let  $\mathbf{Set}_G$  denotes the category of (left)  $G$ -sets, with all maps between  $G$ -sets (not necessarily equivariant) being the morphisms, the above adjunction can be promoted to  $\mathbf{Ob} : \mathbf{Cat}_G \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}_G$ , and  $\mathcal{E} : \mathbf{Set}_G \rightarrow \mathbf{Cat}_G$ . Also, similar notions hold when transfer from left to right  $G$ -sets/categories.

In this exposition we only need  $\mathcal{E}$  to be a right adjoint, there are richer details demonstrated in [3],

## 4 Operads, Operadic Algebra, and Operad $\mathcal{P}$

### 4.1 Symmetric Monoidal Categories

**Definition 4.1.** A category  $\mathcal{V}$  is a *symmetric monoidal category*, if there is a bifunctor  $\otimes : \mathcal{V} \times \mathcal{V} \rightarrow \mathcal{V}$  (called *monoidal product*), and an object  $\kappa \in \mathcal{V}$  (called *unit/monoidal unit*), together with the following natural isomorphisms:

- The *associator*  $a : (-_1 \otimes -_2) \otimes -_3 \xrightarrow{\sim} -_1 \otimes (-_2 \otimes -_3)$ .
- The *left unit*  $\lambda : \kappa \otimes - \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Id}_{\mathcal{V}}$  and the *right unit*  $\rho : - \otimes \kappa \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Id}_{\mathcal{V}}$ .
- The *Symmetric Braiding*  $B : -_1 \otimes -_2 \xrightarrow{\sim} -_2 \otimes -_1$ , with extra property  $B_{Y,X} : Y \otimes X \rightarrow X \otimes Y$  equals to  $B_{X,Y}^{-1} : X \otimes Y \rightarrow Y \otimes X$ .

They also satisfy the following axioms:

- **(Triangle)**

$$\begin{array}{ccc} (X \otimes \kappa) \otimes Y & \xrightarrow{a_{X,\kappa,Y}} & X \otimes (\kappa \otimes Y) \\ \rho_X \otimes \text{id}_Y \searrow & & \swarrow \text{id}_X \otimes \lambda_Y \\ & X \otimes Y & \end{array}$$

- **(Pentagon)**

$$\begin{array}{ccc} ((X \otimes Y) \otimes Z) \otimes W & \xrightarrow{a_{X \otimes Y, Z, W}} & (X \otimes Y) \otimes (Z \otimes W) \\ \downarrow a_{X,Y,Z} \otimes \text{id}_W & & \downarrow a_{X,Y,Z \otimes W} \\ (X \otimes (Y \otimes Z)) \otimes W & & X \otimes (Y \otimes (Z \otimes W)) \\ \searrow a_{X,Y \otimes Z, W} & & \swarrow \text{id}_X \otimes a_{Y,Z,W} \\ & X \otimes ((Y \otimes Z) \otimes W) & \end{array}$$

- **(Hexagon)**

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} (X \otimes Y) \otimes Z & \xrightarrow{a_{X,Y,Z}} & X \otimes (Y \otimes Z) & \xrightarrow{B_{X,Y \otimes Z}} & (Y \otimes Z) \otimes X \\ \downarrow B_{X,Y} \otimes \text{id}_Z & & & & \downarrow a_{Y,Z,X} \\ (Y \otimes X) \otimes Z & \xrightarrow{a_{Y,X,Z}} & Y \otimes (X \otimes Z) & \xrightarrow{\text{id}_Y \otimes B_{X,Z}} & Y \otimes (Z \otimes X) \end{array}$$

Based on *MacLane's Coherence Theorem*, the above two axioms guarantees all finite sequences of  $a, \lambda, \rho$  and their inverses agree, namely there is a unique isomorphism  $P_1 \rightarrow P_2$ , where  $P_i$  are (possibly) different orders of performing product on  $X_1, \dots, X_n \in \mathcal{V}$ . For details, cf. [11].

The category of sets **Set**, small categories **Cat** in 3.3, and small  $G$ -categories **Cat<sub>G</sub>** in 3.8 are central examples for this, where the cartesian product  $\mathcal{A} \times \mathcal{B}$  serves as monoidal product, and the terminal set/category  $*$  serves as units for both.



## 4.2 Operads, Operadic Algebras

**Definition 4.2.** Given symmetric monoidal category  $\mathcal{V}$ , a  $\Sigma$  *operad*  $\mathcal{C}$  in  $\mathcal{V}$  is a collection of objects  $\{\mathcal{C}(j) \in \mathcal{V}\}_{j \in \mathbb{N}}$ , each  $\mathcal{C}(j)$  with a right  $\Sigma_j$ -action (a group homomorphism  $\Sigma_j^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{Aut}_{\mathcal{V}}(\mathcal{C}(j))$ ), a *unit map*  $\eta : 1 \rightarrow \mathcal{C}(1)$ , together with composition maps

$$\gamma : \mathcal{C}(k) \otimes \mathcal{C}(j_1) \otimes \dots \otimes \mathcal{C}(j_k) \rightarrow \mathcal{C}(j_1 + \dots + j_k)$$

that satisfies the following axioms:

- *Unit:*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{C}(j) \otimes \kappa^{\otimes j} & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \mathcal{C}(j) \\ \searrow \text{id}_{\mathcal{C}(j)} \otimes \eta^{\otimes j} & & \nearrow \gamma \\ & \mathcal{C}(j) \otimes \mathcal{C}(1)^{\otimes j} & \end{array} \quad , \quad \begin{array}{ccc} \kappa \otimes \mathcal{C}(j) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \mathcal{C}(j) \\ \searrow \eta \otimes \text{id}_{\mathcal{C}(j)} & & \nearrow \gamma \\ & \mathcal{C}(1) \otimes \mathcal{C}(j) & \end{array}$$

- *Associativity:* Fix natural numbers  $k, j = \sum_{s=1}^k j_s$ , define index  $g_s := j_1 + \dots + j_s$  for  $1 \leq s \leq k$ . For each  $i_1, \dots, i_{g_k} = i_j$ , with sum  $i = \sum_{r=1}^j i_r$ , and  $h_s := i_{g_{(s-1)+1}} + \dots + i_{g_s}$  (so  $i = \sum_{s=1}^k h_s$  also), the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \left[ \mathcal{C}(k) \otimes \left( \bigotimes_{s=1}^k \mathcal{C}(j_s) \right) \right] \otimes \left( \bigotimes_{r=1}^j \mathcal{C}(i_r) \right) & \xrightarrow{\gamma \otimes \text{id}} & \mathcal{C}(j) \otimes \left( \bigotimes_{r=1}^j \mathcal{C}(i_r) \right) \\ \downarrow \text{shuffle} & & \downarrow \gamma \\ \mathcal{C}(k) \otimes \left[ \bigotimes_{s=1}^k \left( \mathcal{C}(j_s) \otimes \left( \bigotimes_{q=1}^{j_s} \mathcal{C}(i_{g_{(s-1)+q}}) \right) \right) \right] & \xrightarrow{\text{id}_{\mathcal{C}(k)} \otimes (\bigotimes_s \gamma)} & \mathcal{C}(k) \otimes \left( \bigotimes_{s=1}^k \mathcal{C}(h_s) \right) \\ & & \uparrow \gamma \\ & & \mathcal{C}(i) \end{array}$$

- *Equivariance:*

- Given  $\sigma \in \Sigma_k$ ,  $j_1 + \dots + j_k = \Sigma_j$ , let  $\sigma(j_1, \dots, j_k) \in \Sigma_j$  denotes “permutation of  $k$ -blocks of letters”, by  $(j_1, \dots, j_k) \mapsto (j_{\sigma^{-1}(1)}, \dots, j_{\sigma^{-1}(k)})$ . Then, the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{C}(k) \otimes \left( \bigotimes_{r=1}^k \mathcal{C}(j_r) \right) & \xrightarrow{\sigma \otimes \sigma^{-1}} & \mathcal{C}(k) \otimes \left( \bigotimes_{r=1}^k \mathcal{C}(j_{\sigma(r)}) \right) \\ \gamma \downarrow & & \downarrow \gamma \\ \mathcal{C}(j) & \xrightarrow{\sigma(j_{\sigma(1)}, \dots, j_{\sigma(k)})} & \mathcal{C}(j) \end{array}$$

- Given  $\tau_r \in \Sigma_{j_r}$ , denote  $\tau_1 \oplus \dots \oplus \tau_k \in \Sigma_j$  by letting each  $\tau_r$  permuting the  $j_r$ th block in  $j$ . Then, the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{C}(k) \otimes \left( \bigotimes_{r=1}^k \mathcal{C}(j_r) \right) & \xrightarrow{\text{id}_{\mathcal{C}(k)} \otimes (\bigotimes_r \tau_r)} & \mathcal{C}(k) \otimes \left( \bigotimes_{r=1}^k \mathcal{C}(j_r) \right) \\ \gamma \downarrow & & \downarrow \gamma \\ \mathcal{C}(j) & \xrightarrow{\tau_1 \oplus \dots \oplus \tau_k} & \mathcal{C}(j) \end{array}$$

If  $\mathcal{C}(0) = \kappa$  (with  $\gamma : \mathcal{C}(0) \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$  being  $\text{id}_{\mathcal{C}(0)}$ ), the operad is *reduced*.

**Definition 4.3.** Given an operad  $\mathcal{C}$  over a symmetric monoidal category  $\mathcal{V}$ , a  $\mathcal{C}$ -algebra is an object  $A \in \mathcal{V}$ , with collections of morphisms  $\theta : \mathcal{C}(j) \otimes A^j \rightarrow A$ , that satisfies the following axioms:

- *Associativity:* Given  $j = \sum_{i=1}^k j_i$ , the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 \left[ \mathcal{C}(k) \otimes \left( \bigotimes_{i=1}^k \mathcal{C}(j_i) \right) \right] \otimes A^{\otimes j} & \xrightarrow{\gamma \otimes \text{id}_{A^{\otimes j}}} & \mathcal{C}(j) \otimes A^{\otimes j} \\
 \downarrow \text{shuffle} & & \downarrow \theta \\
 \mathcal{C}(k) \otimes \left[ \bigotimes_{i=1}^k (\mathcal{C}(j_i) \otimes A^{\otimes j_i}) \right] & \xrightarrow{\text{id}_{\mathcal{C}(k)} \otimes \theta^k} & \mathcal{C}(k) \otimes A^{\otimes k} \\
 & & \uparrow \theta \\
 & & A
 \end{array}$$

(Note: This part uses the isomorphism  $A^{\otimes j} \cong \bigotimes_{i=1}^k A^{\otimes j_i}$ ).

- *Unit:* The following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 \kappa \otimes A & \xrightarrow{\sim} & A \\
 \searrow \eta \otimes \text{id}_A & & \nearrow \theta \\
 & \mathcal{C}(1) \otimes A &
 \end{array}$$

- *Equivariance:* Given any permutation  $\sigma \in \Sigma_j$ , the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 \mathcal{C}(j) \otimes A^{\otimes j} & \xrightarrow{\sigma \otimes \sigma^{-1}} & \mathcal{C}(j) \otimes A^{\otimes j} \\
 \searrow \theta & & \swarrow \theta \\
 & A &
 \end{array}$$

**Example 4.4.** The *associativity operad*  $\mathcal{M}$  in **Set** is defined as  $\mathcal{M}(j) := \Sigma_j$  (the symmetric group for cardinality  $j$ ), which endows a natural right  $\Sigma_j$ -action via right multiplication. The operadic structure map is given by

$$\gamma : \Sigma_k \times \prod_{r=1}^k \Sigma_{j_r} \rightarrow \Sigma_j, \quad \gamma(\sigma; \tau_1, \dots, \tau_k) := \tau_{\sigma^{-1}(1)} \oplus \dots \oplus \tau_{\sigma^{-1}(k)} \circ \sigma(j_{\sigma(1)}, \dots, j_{\sigma(k)}) \quad (4.5)$$

where  $j = \sum_r j_r$ ,  $\sigma(j_1, \dots, j_k) \in \Sigma_j$  denotes the block permutation of  $j_1, \dots, j_k$  within  $j$  (in order), and  $\tau_1 \oplus \dots \tau_k$  is the image of the embedding  $\oplus : \prod_{r=1}^k \Sigma_{j_r} \rightarrow \Sigma_j$ , by viewing the  $r$ th block as finite set of cardinality  $j_r$ . Inspecting the definitions, the algebra over  $\mathcal{M}$  precisely describes the set theoretic monoids. For more details, cf. [3] Section 4.1.

### 4.3 Permutativity Operad $\mathcal{P}$

Now, recall that the chaotic functor  $\mathcal{E} : \mathbf{Set} \rightarrow \mathbf{Cat}$  is a right adjoint of  $\text{Ob} : \mathbf{Cat} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}$ , in particular it preserves products. Hence, the chaotic categorification  $\mathcal{P}(j) := \mathcal{E}\mathcal{M}(j)$  also has a natural operadic structure, via the identification

$$\mathcal{E}\mathcal{M}(k) \times \prod_{r=1}^k \mathcal{E}\mathcal{M}(j_r) \cong \mathcal{E} \left( \mathcal{M}(k) \times \prod_{r=1}^k \mathcal{M}(j_r) \right) \xrightarrow{\mathcal{E}\gamma} \mathcal{E}\mathcal{M}(j). \quad (4.6)$$

This is called the *permutativity operad in Cat*, or the *Barratt-Eccles operad*. As an abuse of notation, the operadic structure map of  $\mathcal{P}$  is also denoted  $\gamma$ .

## 5 $G$ -Operad $\mathcal{P}_G$ and its Pseudoalgebra

### 5.1 The $G$ -Operad $\mathcal{P}_G$

If view each  $\mathcal{P}(j)$  as a  $G$ -trivial  $G$ -category, it's also an operad in  $\mathbf{Cat}_G$ . Its underlying algebra is called the *naive permutative  $G$ -category*, as specified in [3] Section 4.1, it produces a naive  $G$ -spectrum under equivariant infinite loop space theory. In the same source Section 4.2, a richer equivariant structure is introduced which produces the *equivariant Barratt Eccles  $G$ -operad*  $\mathcal{P}_G$  as follow:

**Definition 5.1.** The  $j$ th category  $\mathcal{P}_G(j) := \mathbf{Cat}(\mathcal{E}G, \mathcal{P}(j))$ , with the operadic structure map determined by the fact that  $\mathbf{Cat}(\mathcal{E}G, \_)$  preserves product:

$$\mathbf{Cat}(\mathcal{E}G, \mathcal{P}(k)) \times \prod_{r=1}^k \mathbf{Cat}(\mathcal{E}G, \mathcal{P}(j_r)) \cong \mathbf{Cat} \left( \mathcal{E}G, \mathcal{P}(k) \times \prod_{r=1}^k \mathcal{P}(j_r) \right) \xrightarrow{\gamma \circ \_} \mathbf{Cat}(\mathcal{E}, \mathcal{P}(j)) \quad (5.2)$$

Abuse of notation, we'll denote the operadic structure map as  $\gamma$  again.

Another formulation can be done by defining  $P_G(j) := \mathbf{Set}(G, \Sigma_j)$  in  $\mathbf{Set}$ , then utilize chaotic functor promoting this to a chaotic operad  $\mathcal{E}\mathbf{Set}(G, \Sigma) \cong \mathcal{P}_G$ .

### 5.2 The 2-Category $\mathcal{P}_G\text{-PsAlg}$

The general notion of operadic pseudoalgebra is defined in [2], [5], and [8]. Here we only take the case when the operad is  $\mathcal{P}_G$ , together with some description of  $G$ -equivariance.

**Definition 5.3** ( $\mathcal{P}_G$ -pseudoalgebra). A  $\mathcal{P}_G$ -pseudoalgebra is a  $G$ -category  $\mathcal{A}$  and operad action functors

$$\theta_j : \mathcal{P}_G(j) \times \mathcal{A}^j \rightarrow \mathcal{A}$$

for each  $n \in \mathbb{N}$ , together with an invertible natural transformation  $\phi_1$  in the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{A} & \xrightarrow{\iota} & \mathcal{P}_G(1) \times \mathcal{A} \\ & \searrow \phi_1 & \downarrow \theta_1 \\ & \text{Id}_{\mathcal{A}} & \mathcal{C} \end{array} \quad (5.4)$$

An invertible natural transformation  $\phi = \phi(k; j_1, \dots, j_k)$  for each diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \left( \prod_{r=1}^k \mathcal{P}_G(j_r) \times \mathcal{A}^{j_r} \right) & \xrightarrow{\text{id} \times \prod_r \theta_{j_r}} & \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \mathcal{A}^k \\ \downarrow \text{shuffle} & \searrow \phi & \downarrow \theta_k \\ \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \prod_{r=1}^k \mathcal{P}_G(j_r) \times \mathcal{A}^{j_+} & \xrightarrow{\gamma \times \text{id}} & \mathcal{P}_G(j_+) \times \mathcal{A}^{j_+} \end{array} \quad (5.5)$$

such that the following strict equivariance hold for  $\theta_j$  and  $\phi$ :

(i) **(Equivariance of  $\theta_j$ )** The following two diagrams commutes for  $\sigma \in \Sigma_j$  and  $g \in G$ :

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{P}_G(j) \times \mathcal{A}^j & \xrightarrow{\sigma \times \sigma^{-1}} & \mathcal{P}_G(j) \times \mathcal{A}^j \\ \theta_j \searrow & & \swarrow \theta_j \\ & \mathcal{A} & \end{array} \quad , \quad \begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{P}_G(j) \times \mathcal{A}^j & \xrightarrow{g \times g^{-1}} & \mathcal{P}_G(j) \times \mathcal{A}^j \\ \theta_j \downarrow & & \downarrow \theta_j \\ \mathcal{A} & \xrightarrow{g^{-1}} & \mathcal{A} \end{array} \quad (5.6)$$

The left is the operadic equivariance, the right is  $G$ -equivariance by asserting a product  $G$ -action on  $\mathcal{P}(j) \times \mathcal{A}^j$ .

(ii) **(Equivariance of  $\phi$ )** The following equalities hold when given  $\sigma \in \Sigma_k$ , and  $\tau_r \in \Sigma_{j_r}$ :

$$\phi(k; j_1, \dots, j_k) = \phi(k; j_{\sigma(1)}, \dots, j_{\sigma(k)}) \circ (\sigma \times \sigma^{-1})$$

$$\phi(k; j_1, \dots, j_k) = \phi(k; j_1, \dots, j_k) \circ (\text{id} \times \prod_r (\tau_r \times \tau_r^{-1}))$$

They also need to satisfy the following coherence properties:

(iii) **(Operadic Composition)** The following pasting diagrams are equal, given  $j_+ = \sum j_r$ ,  $i_r = \sum_s i_{r,s}$ , and  $i_+ = \sum_{r,s} i_{r,s}$  with  $1 \leq r \leq k$  and  $1 \leq s \leq j_r$ :

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
\mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \prod_r (\mathcal{P}_G(j_r) \times \prod_s (\mathcal{P}_G(i_{r,s}) \times \mathcal{A}^{i_{r,s}})) & \xrightarrow{\text{id} \times \prod (\text{id} \times \theta_{i_{r,s}})} & \mathcal{Q}_G(k) \times \prod_r (\mathcal{P}_G(j_r) \times \mathcal{A}^{j_r}) & & \\
\downarrow \gamma \times \text{id} & & \downarrow \gamma & \searrow \text{id} \times \prod \theta_{j_r} & \\
\mathcal{P}_G(j_+) \times \prod_{r,s} (\mathcal{P}_G(i_{r,s}) \times \mathcal{A}^{i_{r,s}}) & \xrightarrow{\text{id} \times \prod \theta_{i_{r,s}}} & \mathcal{P}_G(j_+) \times \mathcal{A}^{j_+} & \xrightarrow{\phi} & \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \mathcal{A}^k \\
& \searrow \gamma \times \text{id} & \downarrow \phi & \searrow \theta_{j_+} & \downarrow \theta_k \\
& & \mathcal{P}_G(i_+) \times \mathcal{A}^{i_+} & \xrightarrow{\theta_{j_+}} & \mathcal{A}
\end{array}$$

equals

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
\mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \prod_r (\mathcal{P}_G(j_r) \times \prod_s (\mathcal{P}_G(i_{r,s}) \times \mathcal{A}^{i_{r,s}})) & \xrightarrow{\text{id} \times \prod (\text{id} \times \theta_{i_{r,s}})} & \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \prod_r (\mathcal{P}_G(j_r) \times \mathcal{A}^{j_r}) & & \\
\downarrow \gamma \times \text{id} & \searrow \text{id} \times \prod (\gamma \times \text{id}) & \downarrow \text{id} \times \prod \phi & \searrow \text{id} \times \prod \theta_{j_r} & \\
\mathcal{P}_G(j_+) \times \prod_{r,s} (\mathcal{P}_G(i_{r,s}) \times \mathcal{A}^{i_{r,s}}) & & \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \prod_r (\mathcal{P}_G(i_r) \times \mathcal{A}^{i_r}) & \xrightarrow{\text{id} \times \prod \gamma} & \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \mathcal{A}^k \\
& \searrow \gamma \times \text{id} & \downarrow \gamma \times \text{id} & \searrow \phi & \downarrow \theta_k \\
& & \mathcal{P}_G(i_+) \times \mathcal{A}^{i_+} & \xrightarrow{\theta_{i_+}} & \mathcal{A}
\end{array}$$

The commuting square above is due to associativity of operad.

(iv) **(Operadic Identity)** The following two pairs of two pasting diagrams are equal:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
 \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \mathcal{A}^k & \xrightarrow{\text{id} \times \iota^k} & \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times (\mathcal{P}_G(1) \times \mathcal{A})^k & \xrightarrow{\text{id} \times \theta_1^k} & \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \mathcal{A}^k \\
 & & \downarrow \text{shuffle} & & \downarrow \theta_k \\
 & & \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \mathcal{P}_G(1)^k \times \mathcal{A}^k & \xrightarrow{\phi} & \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \mathcal{A}^k \\
 & & \downarrow \gamma \times \text{id} & \nearrow & \downarrow \theta_k \\
 & & \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \mathcal{A}^k & \xrightarrow{\theta_k} & \mathcal{A}
 \end{array}$$

equals

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
 & & \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times (\mathcal{P}_G(1) \times \mathcal{A})^k & & \\
 & \nearrow \text{id} \times \iota^k & \downarrow \text{id} \times \Pi \phi & \nwarrow \text{id} \times \theta_1^k & \\
 \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \mathcal{A}^k & \xrightarrow{\text{id}} & \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \mathcal{A}^k & \xrightarrow{\theta_k} & \mathcal{A} \\
 \downarrow \text{id} \times \iota^k & \searrow \iota^k & \nearrow \gamma \times \text{id} & & \\
 \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times (\mathcal{P}_G(1) \times \mathcal{A})^k & \xrightarrow{\text{shuffle}} & \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \mathcal{P}_G(1)^k \times \mathcal{A}^k & & 
 \end{array}$$

(The two triangles right above commutes due to the unit axioms of operad).

Also:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
 \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \mathcal{A}^k & \xrightarrow{\iota} & \mathcal{P}_G(1) \times \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \mathcal{A}^k & \xrightarrow{\text{id} \times \theta_k} & \mathcal{P}_G(1) \times \mathcal{A} \\
 & \searrow \text{id} & \downarrow \gamma \times \text{id} & \nearrow \phi & \downarrow \theta_1 \\
 & & \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \mathcal{A}^k & \xrightarrow{\theta_k} & \mathcal{A}
 \end{array}$$

equals

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \mathcal{A}^k & \xrightarrow{\iota} & \mathcal{P}_G(1) \times \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \mathcal{A}^k \\
 \downarrow \theta_k & & \downarrow \text{id} \times \theta_k \\
 \mathcal{A} & \xrightarrow{\iota} & \mathcal{P}_G(1) \times \mathcal{A} \\
 & \searrow \phi_1 & \downarrow \theta_1 \\
 & & \mathcal{A}
 \end{array}$$

The first diagram's triangle commutes due to the operadic unit axiom.

**Remark 5.7.** In [2] Corner and Gurski includes unital natural isomorphisms, while in [5] it requires strict unitality. The main result in nonequivariant case of [8] alleviates the result from strict unitality.

**Definition 5.8** ( $\mathcal{P}_G$ -pseudomorphism). A  $\mathcal{P}_G$ -pseudomorphism  $(\mathbb{F}, \zeta) : (\mathcal{A}, \theta, \phi) \rightarrow (\mathcal{B}, \vartheta, \varphi)$  consists of functor  $\mathbb{F} : \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ , such that for each  $j$  in the folloigin diagram commutes up to an invertible natural

transformation  $\zeta_j$ :

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 \mathcal{P}_G(j) \times \mathcal{A}^j & \xrightarrow{\text{id} \times \mathbb{F}^j} & \mathcal{P}_G(j) \times \mathcal{B}^j \\
 \theta_j \downarrow & \swarrow \zeta_j & \downarrow \vartheta_j \\
 \mathcal{A} & \xrightarrow{\mathbb{F}} & \mathcal{B}
 \end{array}$$

Moreover, they satisfy the following properties:

- (i) **(Equivariance of  $\zeta$ )** For each  $j, \zeta_j = \zeta_j \circ (\sigma \times \sigma^{-1})$  for all  $\sigma \in \Sigma_j$ . **Check  $G$ -equivariance**
- (ii) **(Preserves Identity)** The following two pasting diagrams are equal:

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 \mathcal{A} & \xrightarrow{\mathbb{F}} & \mathcal{B} \\
 \downarrow \iota & & \downarrow \iota \\
 \mathcal{P}_G(1) \times \mathcal{A} & \xrightarrow{\text{id} \times \mathbb{F}} & \mathcal{P}_G(1) \times \mathcal{B} \\
 \downarrow \theta_1 & \searrow \varphi_1 & \downarrow \vartheta_1 \\
 \mathcal{A} & \xrightarrow{\mathbb{F}} & \mathcal{B}
 \end{array}
 \quad = \quad
 \begin{array}{ccc}
 \mathcal{A} & \xrightarrow{\mathbb{F}} & \mathcal{B} \\
 \downarrow \iota & \searrow \text{id} & \downarrow \text{id} \\
 \mathcal{P}_G(1) \times \mathcal{A} & \xrightarrow{\theta_1} & \mathcal{A} \xrightarrow{\mathbb{F}} \mathcal{B}
 \end{array}$$

- (iii) **(Preserves Composition)** The following two pasting diagrams are equal:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
 \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \prod_r (\mathcal{P}_G(j_r) \times \mathcal{A}^{j_r}) & \xrightarrow{\text{id} \times \prod (\text{id} \times \mathbb{F}^{j_r})} & \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \prod_r (\mathcal{P}_G(j_r) \times \mathcal{B}^{j_r}) & & \\
 \downarrow \gamma & \searrow \text{id} \times \prod \theta_{j_r} & \swarrow \text{id} \times \prod \zeta_{j_r} & \searrow \text{id} \times \prod \vartheta_{j_r} & \\
 & \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \mathcal{A}^k & \xrightarrow{\text{id} \times \mathbb{F}^k} & \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \mathcal{B}^k & \\
 \swarrow \phi & \downarrow \theta_k & \swarrow \zeta_k & \downarrow \vartheta_k & \\
 \mathcal{P}_G(j) \times \mathcal{A}^j & \xrightarrow{\theta_j} & \mathcal{A} & \xrightarrow{\mathbb{F}} & \mathcal{B}
 \end{array}$$

equals

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
 \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \prod_r (\mathcal{P}_G(j_r) \times \mathcal{A}^{j_r}) & \xrightarrow{\text{id} \times \prod (\text{id} \times \mathbb{F}^{j_r})} & \mathcal{P}_G(k) \times \prod_r (\mathcal{P}_G(j_r) \times \mathcal{B}^{j_r}) & & \\
 \downarrow \gamma & & \downarrow \gamma & \searrow \text{id} \times \prod \theta_{j_r} & \\
 \mathcal{P}_G(j) \times \mathcal{A}^j & \xrightarrow{\text{id} \times \mathbb{F}^j} & \mathcal{P}_G(j) \times \mathcal{B}^j & \searrow \vartheta_j & \\
 \downarrow \theta_j & \swarrow \zeta_j & \downarrow \vartheta_j & \downarrow \vartheta_k & \\
 \mathcal{A} & \xrightarrow{\mathbb{F}} & \mathcal{B} & & 
 \end{array}$$

**Definition 5.9** ( $\mathcal{P}_G$ -2-cells). Let  $(\mathbb{F}, \zeta), (\mathbb{G}, \xi) : (\mathcal{A}, \theta, \phi) \rightarrow (\mathcal{B}, \vartheta, \varphi)$  be two  $\mathcal{P}_G$ -pseudomorphisms, a  $\mathcal{P}_G$ -2-cell  $\lambda : (\mathbb{F}, \zeta) \Rightarrow (\mathbb{G}, \xi)$  is a natural transformation  $\lambda : \mathbb{F} \rightarrow \mathbb{G}$ , such that the following two pasting diagrams are equal:

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 \begin{array}{ccc}
 & \xrightarrow{\text{id} \times \mathbb{F}^j} & \\
 \mathcal{P}_G(j) \times \mathcal{A}^j & \xrightarrow{\text{id} \times \lambda^j} & \mathcal{P}_G(j) \times \mathcal{B}^j \\
 & \xleftarrow{\text{id} \times \mathbb{G}^j} & \\
 \downarrow \theta_j & \searrow \xi_j & \downarrow \vartheta_j \\
 \mathcal{A} & \xrightarrow{\mathbb{G}} & \mathcal{B}
 \end{array}
 & = &
 \begin{array}{ccc}
 & \xrightarrow{\text{id} \times \mathbb{F}^j} & \\
 \mathcal{P}_G(j) \times \mathcal{A}^j & \xrightarrow{\text{id} \times \mathbb{F}^j} & \mathcal{P}_G(j) \times \mathcal{B}^j \\
 & \xleftarrow{\text{id} \times \mathbb{G}^j} & \\
 \downarrow \theta_j & \searrow \zeta_j & \downarrow \vartheta_j \\
 \mathcal{A} & \xrightarrow[\lambda]{\mathbb{F}} & \mathcal{B}
 \end{array}
 \end{array}$$

## 6 Category $\mathcal{F}_G$ and its Pseudoalgebras

Within the equivariant infinite loop space machine, the purpose for  $\mathcal{F}_G$ -pseudoalgebras (after strictifying to algebras) are to construct  $\mathcal{F}_G$ -spaces, which are collections of  $G$ -spaces indexed over finite based  $G$ -sets (and morphisms between them encoding extra structure). The  $\mathcal{F}_G$ -spaces are primary inputs in producing a genuine  $G$ -spectra, and the other main character we wish to study the correspondance. For details of  $\mathcal{F}_G$ -spaces, cf. [14] Section 1 (which is named after  $\Gamma_G$  instead of  $\mathcal{F}_G$ ).

The following definitions are equivariant generalizations of  $\mathcal{F}$ -pseudofunctors in [8], and we'll utilize similar notations.

**Definition 6.1.**  $\mathcal{F}_G$  denotes the *category of based finite sets*, where the objects are  $\mathbf{n}^\alpha$ , set wise being the finite set  $\{0, 1, \dots, n\}$  with 0 fixed as the basepoint, and  $\alpha : G \rightarrow \Sigma_n$  is a based  $G$ -action on the set.

The homset  $\mathcal{F}_G(\mathbf{n}^\alpha, \mathbf{m}^\beta)$  consists of all the based set map, which the homset also endows with a  $G$ -action via conjugation. From now on, we'll view  $\mathcal{F}_G$  as a 2-category, where each hom-category  $\mathcal{F}_G(\mathbf{n}^\alpha, \mathbf{m}^\beta)$  is discrete with only identity 2-cells.

Furthermore, we define the following:

- $\Pi_G \subset \mathcal{F}_G$  denotes the subcategory where each morphism  $\phi : \mathbf{n}^\alpha \rightarrow \mathbf{m}^\beta$  satisfies  $|\phi^{-1}(j)| = 0, 1$  for all  $j \neq 0$ .
- $\Lambda_G, \Lambda_G^\perp, \Sigma_G \subset \Pi_G$  denotes the subcategory where each morphism is injective, surjective, and bijective respectively (in particular,  $\Lambda_G \cap \Lambda_G^\perp = \Sigma_G$ ).
- $\mathcal{E}_G \subset \mathcal{F}_G$  denotes the subcategory where each morphism satisfies  $\phi^{-1}(0) = \{0\}$ .

We also denote the map  $\phi_{\mathbf{n}^\alpha} : \mathbf{n}^\alpha \rightarrow \mathbf{1}$  (with  $j \mapsto 1$  for all  $j \neq 0$ ) in  $\mathcal{E}$  as the *canonical product*.

### 6.1 2-Category $\mathcal{F}_G$ -PsAlg

**Definition 6.2** ( $\mathcal{F}_G$ -pseudoalgebra). An  $\mathcal{F}_G$ -pseudoalgebra, is a pseudofunctor  $\mathcal{B} : \mathcal{F}_G \rightarrow \mathbf{Cat}_G$  (cf. Definition 3.4), such that restricting to the subcategory  $\Pi_G \subset \mathcal{F}_G$ ,  $\mathcal{B}$  is a strict functor. Moreover, we require it to be reduced, namely  $\mathcal{B}(0) = *$  (the terminal  $G$ -category), and each hom-functor

$$\mathcal{B}_{\mathbf{n}^\alpha, \mathbf{m}^\beta} : \mathcal{F}_G(\mathbf{n}^\alpha, \mathbf{m}^\beta) \rightarrow \mathbf{Cat}_G(\mathcal{B}(\mathbf{n}^\alpha), \mathcal{B}(\mathbf{m}^\beta))$$

is a  $G$ -functor.

Let  $\delta_i : \mathbf{n}^\alpha \rightarrow \mathbf{1}$  be the  $i$ th projection (namely  $i \mapsto 1$ , and any  $i \neq j \mapsto 0$ ), since it belongs to  $\Pi_G$ , it generates a functor  $\mathcal{B}\delta_i : \mathcal{B}(\mathbf{n}^\alpha) \rightarrow \mathcal{B}(\mathbf{1})$ . Hence, by universality of product, the collection  $\mathcal{B}\delta_i$  ( $1 \leq i \leq n$ ) induces a functor  $\delta : \mathcal{B}(\mathbf{n}^\alpha) \rightarrow \mathcal{B}(\mathbf{1})^{\mathbf{n}^\alpha}$  (where  $\mathcal{B}(\mathbf{1})^{\mathbf{n}} \cong \mathcal{B}(\mathbf{1})^{\mathbf{n}^\alpha}$  nonequivariantly).

**Definition 6.3** ( $\mathcal{F}_{G, \text{vs}}$  and  $\mathcal{F}_{G, \mathbb{R}}$ -pseudoalgebra). An  $\mathcal{F}_G$ -pseudoalgebra  $\mathcal{B}$  is *very special* (or an  $\mathcal{F}_{G, \text{vs}}$ -pseudoalgebra), if  $\delta : \mathcal{B}(\mathbf{n}^\alpha) \rightarrow \mathcal{B}(\mathbf{1})^{\mathbf{n}^\alpha}$  is an isomorphism for all  $\mathbf{n}^\alpha \in \mathcal{F}_G$ , and  $\mathcal{B}$  is *strictly special* (or an  $\mathcal{F}_{G, \mathbb{R}}$ -pseudoalgebra), if all  $\delta$  is in fact identity.



**Definition 6.4** ( $\mathcal{F}_G$ -1-cell). Given  $\mathcal{A}, \mathcal{B}$  two  $\mathcal{F}_G$ -pseudoalgebras, a morphism (or  $\mathcal{F}_G$ -1-cell) between them is a pseudotransform  $(\mathbb{F}, \zeta) : \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$  (cf. Definition 3.5), such that restricting to  $\Pi_G$ , it becomes an actual natural transformation. Moreover, it respects  $G$ -equivariance for every  $g \in G$  and morphism  $f \in \text{Mor}(\mathcal{F}_G)$ :

$$\zeta(g \circ f \circ g^{-1}) = g \circ \zeta(f) \circ g^{-1}$$

**Definition 6.5** ( $\mathcal{F}_G$ -2-cell). Given  $\tilde{A}, \tilde{B}$  two  $\mathcal{F}_G$ -pseudoalgebras, and two  $\mathcal{F}_G$ -1-cells  $(\mathbb{F}, \zeta), (\mathbb{G}, \xi) : \tilde{A} \rightarrow \tilde{B}$ , an  $\mathcal{F}_G$ -2-cell is a modification  $\lambda : \mathbb{F} \Rightarrow \mathbb{G}$  (cf. Definition 3.6), such that for any morphism  $f : \mathbf{n}^\alpha \rightarrow \mathbf{m}^\beta$  in  $\mathcal{F}_G$ , the following two pasting diagrams are equal:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{A}(\mathbf{n}^\alpha) & \xrightleftharpoons[\mathbb{G}_{\mathbf{n}^\alpha}]{\mathbb{F}_{\mathbf{n}^\alpha}} & \mathcal{B}(\mathbf{n}^\alpha) \\ \mathcal{A}f \downarrow & \searrow \xi f & \downarrow \mathcal{B}f \\ \mathcal{A}(\mathbf{m}^\beta) & \xrightarrow{\mathbb{G}_{\mathbf{m}^\beta}} & \mathcal{B}(\mathbf{m}^\beta) \end{array} = \begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{A}(\mathbf{n}^\alpha) & \xrightarrow{\mathbb{F}_{\mathbf{n}^\alpha}} & \mathcal{B}(\mathbf{n}^\alpha) \\ \mathcal{B}f \downarrow & \swarrow \zeta f & \downarrow \mathcal{B}f \\ \mathcal{A}(\mathbf{m}^\beta) & \xrightleftharpoons[\mathbb{G}_{\mathbf{m}^\beta}]{\lambda} & \mathcal{B}(\mathbf{m}^\beta) \end{array}$$

## 7 Transition to Equivariant Correspondance

The eventual goal is constructing an  $\mathcal{F}_{G,\mathbb{R}}$ -pseudoalgebra out of an  $\mathcal{P}_G$ -pseudoalgebra, while extend it to a 2-functor. [8] provides a general construction for the non-equivariant case (or  $G = \mathbf{1}$ ).

Given a  $\mathcal{P}$ -pseudoalgebra  $\mathcal{A}$ , define object map  $\mathcal{B} : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathbf{Cat}$  by  $\mathcal{B}(\mathbf{n}) := \mathcal{A}^n$ . For extending to a pseudofunctor (and restricting to functor on  $\Pi$ ), the central concepts include:

- (i) Substituting the vanishing coordinates of maps  $\psi : \mathbf{n} \rightarrow \mathbf{m}$  in  $\Pi$  using the specified basepoint  $\theta_0 : * \cong \mathcal{P}(0) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}$ . In particular, since each  $j \in \mathbf{m}$  has preimage being empty or a singleton, define  $\psi : \mathcal{A}^n \rightarrow \mathcal{A}^m$  by

$$\psi(a_1, \dots, a_n) := (a_{\psi^{-1}(1)}, \dots, a_{\psi^{-1}(m)}), \quad (7.1)$$

with  $a_{\psi^{-1}(j)} := *$  (the basepoint) if  $\psi^{-1}(j) = \emptyset$ . This defines  $\mathcal{B}$  to be a functor with source  $\Pi$ .

- (ii) Treating each canonical  $n$ -fold product  $\phi_n : \mathbf{n} \rightarrow \mathbf{1}$  in  $\mathcal{E}$  (with  $\phi_n(j) = 1$  for all  $j \neq 0$ ) using the  $n$ -fold product  $e \times \mathcal{A} \hookrightarrow \mathcal{P}(n) \times \mathcal{A} \xrightarrow{\gamma} \mathcal{A}$ .
- (iii) Finally, show the decomposition laws, that maps in  $\mathcal{E}$  are compositions of permutation and wedge of canonical products (when fixing a specific order, it's unique), while maps in  $\mathcal{F}$  decomposes into a projection and a map in  $\mathcal{E}$ . Using the laws to construct functors  $\mathcal{A}^n \rightarrow \mathcal{A}^m$  using each map  $\psi$ .

The coherent natural isomorphisms for  $\mathcal{P}$ -pseudoalgebra provides the pseudofunctoriality modulo extensive diagram chasing.

Step (i) is generalizes naturally to the equivariant case, as each  $\mathcal{P}_G$ -pseudoalgebra  $\mathcal{A}$  has a natural basepoint specified by  $\theta_0 : * \cong \mathcal{P}_G(0) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}$ , each  $\mathcal{A}^{\mathbf{n}^\alpha} \cong \mathcal{A}^n$  nonequivariantly, and the maps in  $\Pi_G$  includes all nonequivariant ones, hence the same construction carries over.

For (ii), each canonical product  $\phi_{\mathbf{n}^\alpha} : \mathbf{n}^\alpha \rightarrow \mathbf{1}$  has a choice given by  $\alpha \times \mathcal{A}^n \hookrightarrow \mathcal{P}_G(n) \times \mathcal{A}^n \xrightarrow{\theta_n} \mathcal{A}$  (by treating  $\alpha$ ), with some equivariance details we'll specify below.

For (iii), the main problem for equivariant case is: Not every map can be expressed as wedges of canonical product, as the preimage of an element may not necessarily be wedges of  $G$ -orbits. So, potentially some choices

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